

KF Reading Guide

Chapter 4: *Neurotic Pride*¹

1. With all their strenuous efforts toward perfection, what do neurotics fail to attain? (86.1)
2. What do children need to develop basic self-confidence? (86.2)
3. What factors in your upbringing may have been injurious to healthy growth? (87.2)
4. What area is weakened by neurotic development? (87.3)
5. How do neurotics attempt to remedy the damage caused by self-alienation? (87.3)
6. Instead of solid self-confidence, what does self-idealization give neurotics? (87.3)
7. What seems mysterious, arising from nowhere but most desirable for the neurotic? (87.4)
8. What does the patient not know and is anxious not to realize? (88.1)
9. What is healthy pride based upon? (88.3)
10. Neurotic pride is extremely sensitive to what emotion? (88.4)
11. How do neurotics relate to the group? (89.4–90.1)

12. What is unhealthy about chasing prestige? (90.2)
13. What are neurotics NOT proud of? (90.3)
14. For what do neurotics have no appreciation at all? (90.3)
15. How do neurotics maintain their private fictitious world? (91.3)
16. What is a regular occurrence in all neurosis? (92.1)
17. Which of these or other areas of pride do you recognize in yourself? (92.2)
18. Why do the actual flaws of neurotics not count? (93.2)
19. Are people proud of the same things? (93.3)
20. Our neurotic pride will not tolerate the idea of being in the clutches of blind needs, so what must we do? (93.4–94.1)
21. As soon as we go off on a search for glory, what happens? (94.3)
22. When are neurotics unable to regard a drive, an attitude, or a reaction as a problem to be tackled? (95.2)

23. What are the two reactions to hurt pride? (95.3)
- A.
 - B.
24. When do we feel ashamed? (95.3)
25. When do we feel humiliated? (95.3)
26. What two questions must we answer when any reaction of shame or humiliation seems out of place or out of proportion? (96.1)
- A.
 - B.
27. What are we inclined to think determines our reactions? (97.2)
28. What determines our reactions more than the situation itself? (97.2)
29. Why do aggressive expansive types often not react with feelings of shame? (97.3)
30. Why do self-effacing types feel easily ashamed? (97.4)
31. What inner condition greatly contributes to a diffuse irritability? (98.2)
32. Other than shame and humiliation, direct reactions to hurt pride can be automatically transformed into what feelings? (98.3)
33. What are the prominent secondary reactions to hurt pride? (99.2)
- A.
 - B.
34. When is the connection between hostility and hurt pride more easily discernible? (99.3)

35. What would save us from many painful or even heartbreaking troubles? (100.2)
36. What do we fear when we cannot perform to the exacting standards of our shoulds? (101.1).
37. For you, what activities stir up fear of rejection? (101.2)
38. Why do both rage and fear occur? (102.2)
39. What two alternatives are open to the neurotic? (102.2)
- A.
- B.
40. How do neurotics remedy the unbearable tension created by a pride system that they need but which at the same time makes them so vulnerable? (103.2)
41. The most effective way to save face is interlinked with what? (103.3)
42. What do we believe will be happen if we get back at the offender? (103.3)
43. What gives vindictiveness its incredible tenacity and accounts for its compulsive nature (103.3)

44. In the minds of certain types, the power to retaliate is equal to what? (103.4)
45. What is the next most important method of restoring pride? (104.3)
46. When we lose interest in a relationship, what may actually have happened? (105.2)
47. What is the most ruinous aspect of withdrawing from relationships? (105.3)
48. Which of these methods of restoring pride have you seen in yourself or others? (104.3–106.3)
49. What do all these devices for restoring pride have in common? (106.1)
50. How does the neurotic avoid future hurt to pride? (106.4)
51. What is the enemy of love? (108.1)

¹ This reading guide refers to the 1991 edition of *Neurosis and Human Growth: The Struggle Toward Self-Realization* by Karen Horney, published by W.W. Norton and Company Inc. New York.